

[Return to Search](#)

Southeast Nuba social relations

Author(S): Faris, James C.

Document Type: Book

Original Page: 166

Culture (OWC): [Nuba \(FJ21\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1966-1969, 1977, 1980

Coverage Date: 1966 AD - 1980 AD

Place Coverage: Southeastern South Kordofan, Sudan

Section Title(S)

2) Incest Prohibitions and Kin Terminology

Exogamic violations are, of course, known, but incest is only known from its consequences - leprosy, or barrenness in females, or genital swelling in males. I was told that the actual mechanism resulting in these consequences (from a man having two female lovers from the same matriclan section, or a woman sleeping with two men of the same matriclan) was the mixing of fluids of the kin so involved.

684
[Sex And Marital Offenses](#)

753
[Theory Of Disease](#)

784
[Avoidance And Taboo](#)

835
[Kinship Regulation Of Sex](#)

Sexual joking with *danndanna* of the opposite sex is appropriate, as it is an appropriate marriage category. But it is not good to take a *danndanna* as a lover after marriage, for in the case of a MBD, for example, the payments which might be required in wife theft cases (inspired by the British in an ostensible attempt to stabilize marriage, an attempt that failed except to fill the coffers of the British-inspired Native Administrator, the *omda*) may mean that a mother's brother, normally the person to whom one goes to secure cattle for a wife theft payment, is also the father of the woman stolen. While *danndanna* initial marriages are encouraged, it is quite another matter for a man to have to surrender cattle to have his daughter married to her *danndanna*. It is expressed as a man paying to have his daughter stolen. This may be examined in actual fact, however, from [Cross-Reference: \(Table 20\)](#), the incident of *danndanna* stolen, initially married, etc. are noted (*danndanna*

522
[Humor](#)

684
[Sex And Marital Offenses](#)

835
[Kinship Regulation Of Sex](#)

are also discussed in the context of marriage below). It may be useful here to summarize the types of relationships possible and their sanctions in various categories of matrikin relations. These may be compared with patrikin relationships below.

Action	Consequence Between Matriclan Section	Consequence Between Offspring of Matriclan Section
Mating	incest, possibly witchcraft	preferred (if opposite sex)
Fighting	witchcraft	leprosy

784

Avoidance And Taboo

828

Ethnopsychology

835

Kinship Regulation Of Sex

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#)

· [Accessibility](#)

· [Cookie Policy](#)